

Statistics

[Table 34.2](#) shows general statistics for flags. The performance statistics do not use the usual ultimate high or low method measure (that is, looking for a 20% trend change). Instead, I looked at the beginning and ending of the price trend (usually the nearest minor high or low after the breakout). Thus, comparing this pattern to other patterns except pennants (which use the same method) is unfair.

Number found. I uncovered 1,278 flags (without really trying) in 462 stocks with the first appearing in October 1991 and the most recent in December 2019. Not all stocks covered the entire period, and some no longer trade. Many flags were just a few days long, and they are a colossal pain to catalog because they are so small and so plentiful.

[Table 34.2](#) General Statistics

Description	Bull Market, Up Breakout	Bear Market, Up Breakout	Bull Market, Down Breakout	Bear Market, Down Breakout
Number found	573	148	384	173
Reversal (R), continuation (C) occurrence	8% R, 92% C	8% R, 92% C	31% R, 69% C	8% R, 92% C
Reversal, continuation performance	6% R, 10% C	8% R, 10% C	−5% R, −9% C	−7% R, −17% C
Average rise or decline	9%	10%	−8%	−16%
Standard & Poor's 500 change	2%	2%	−2%	−5%
Days to trend high or low	10	8	8	10